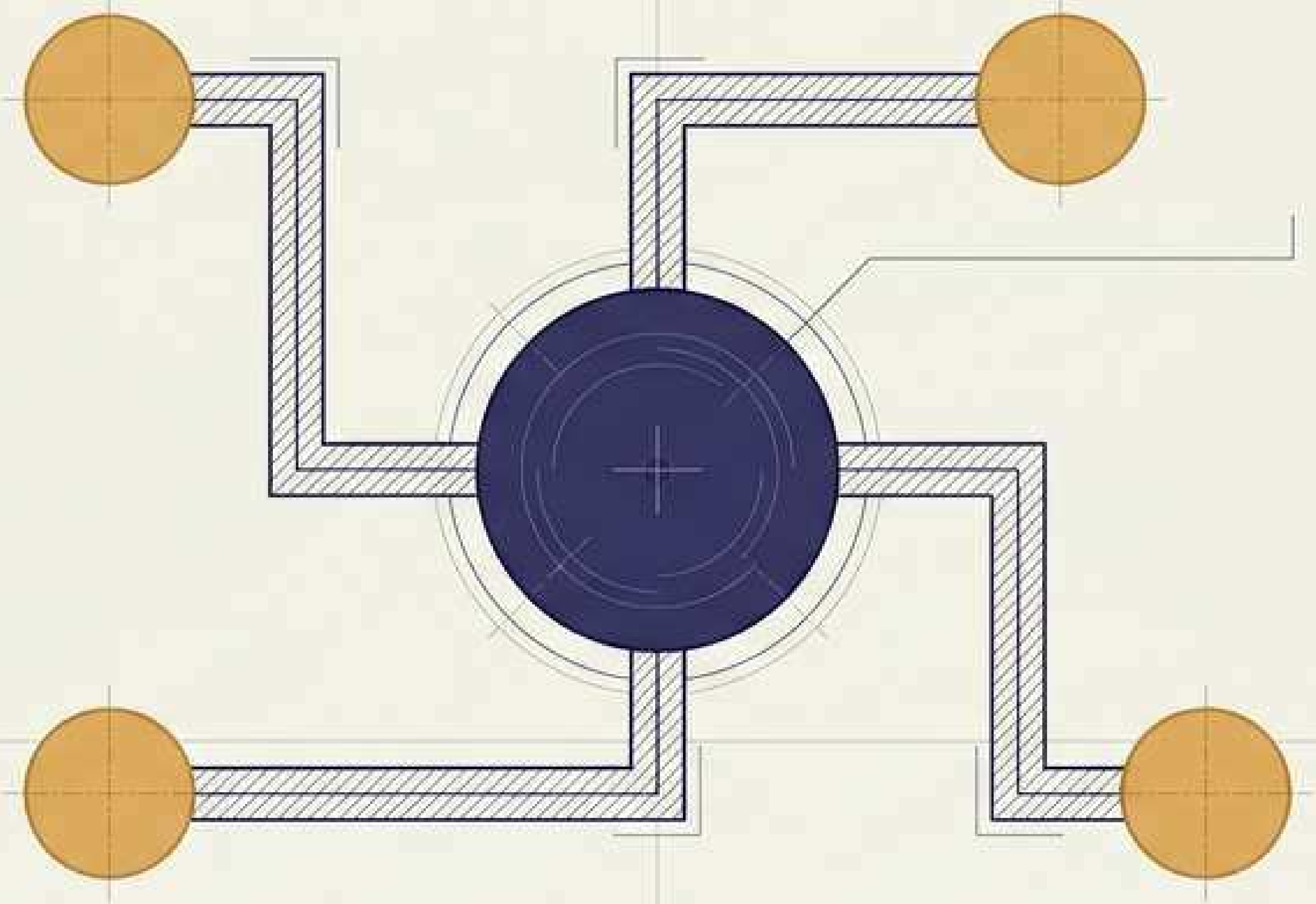
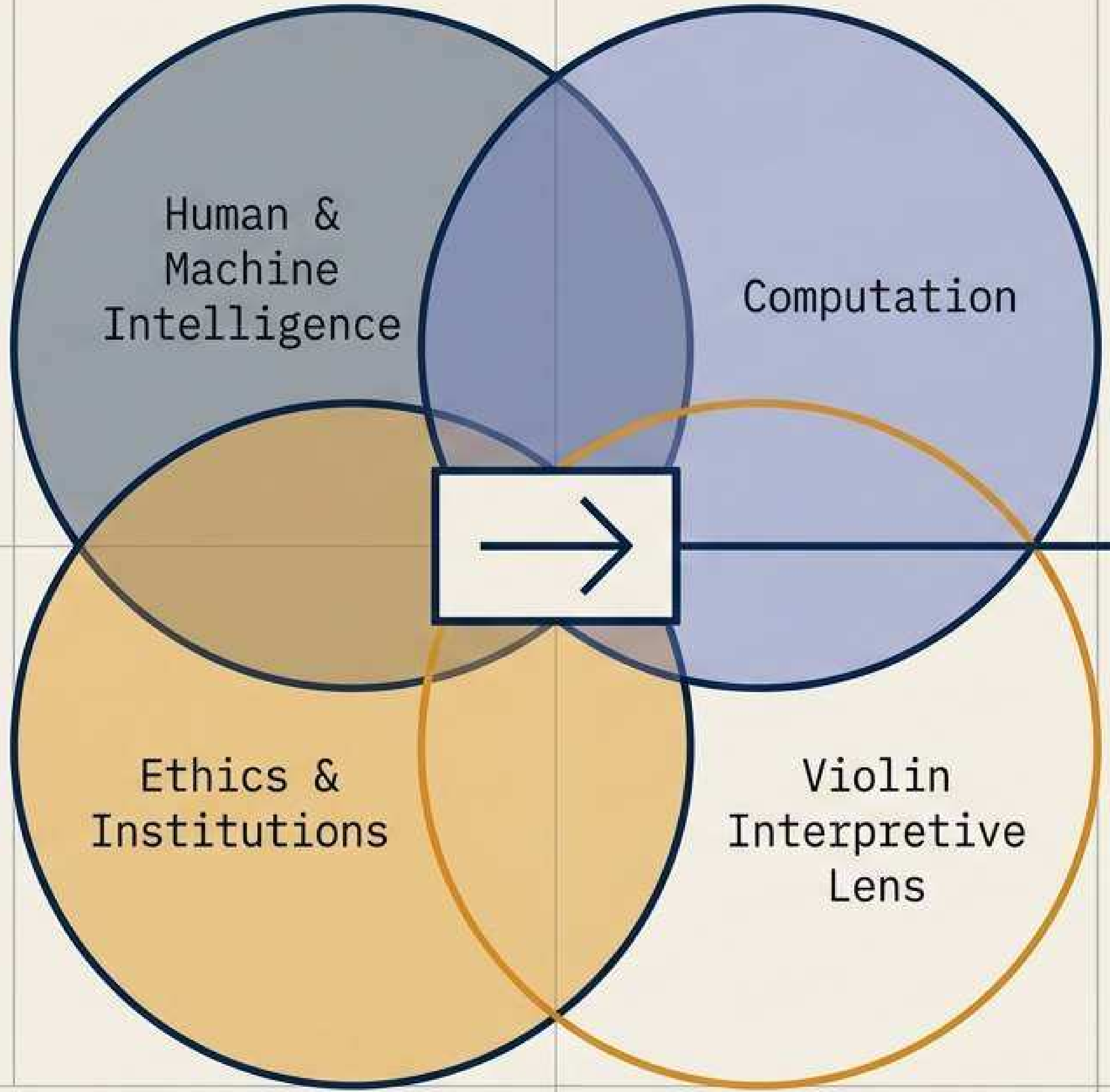


Undergraduate Program Fit Architecture: Eidee Laurel Tan

Focused System Analysis: CMU, UChicago, UPenn, UC Berkeley, UIUC, UW

Prepared for Fall 2027 Entry Planning



The Executive Thesis

Eidee's optimal path is not a generic "pre-law" program. It is a deliberately structured education in **human and machine intelligence, computation, ethics, and institutions**, with law as the eventual application domain.

Standard majors force Eidee to assemble this field from unrelated electives. The target program must architecturally **fuse these domains** into a **single, legible degree**.

The Variable Parameters: Calibrating the Academic Spine

The baseline analysis assumes M0 and E0. Moving these sliders radically shifts the ideal institutional architecture.

Music Intensity

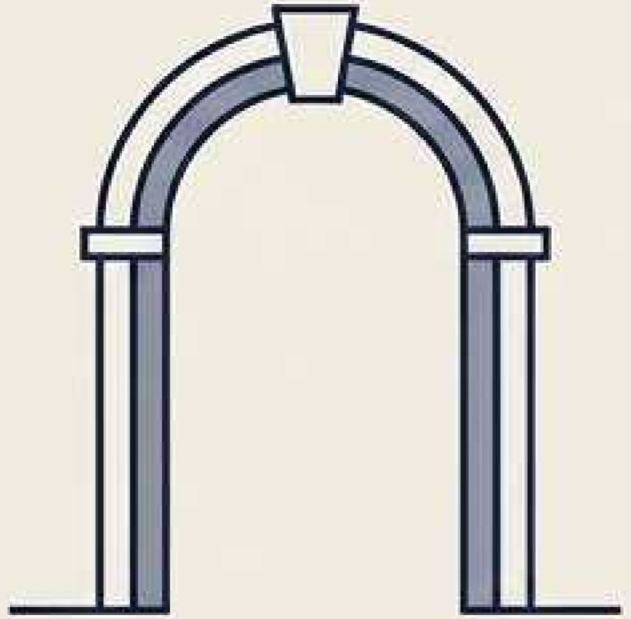
M0	M1	M2
Baseline: High-level non-major. Auditioned orchestra outside the degree.	Curricular artist-scholar. Music formally inside the degree.	Professional combined route. Dual-degree conservatory.

Economics Intensity

E0	E1	E2
Baseline: Economics is a supporting subject (markets, incentives).	Coequal. Economics and AI's impact on markets form the degree spine.	Primary. Economics is the dominant focus of the degree.

The Feasibility Index: Understanding Admission Gates

Not all published programs are structurally available upon enrollment. Each university pathway is tagged with a Feasibility Gate.

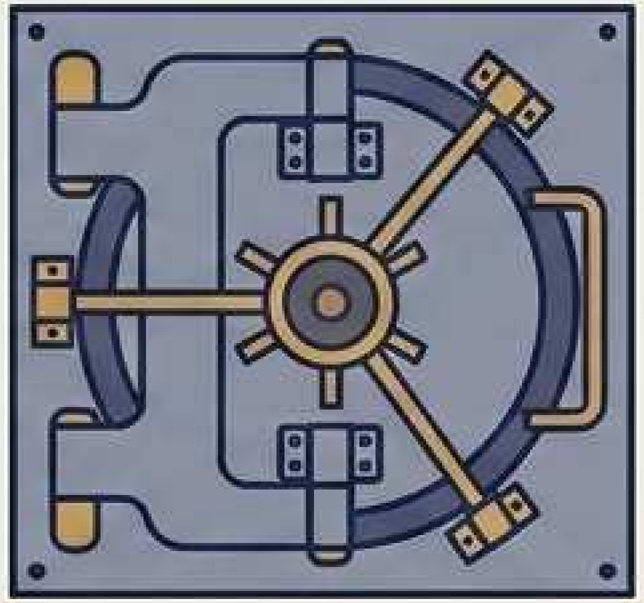


G3: Open Pathway

Structurally available. The pathway is ordinarily accessible after university admission if published course prerequisites are met.

G2: Internal Gate

Application dependent. Requires a secondary application, adviser approval, or audition (e.g., Music) after initial admission.



G3-DTM: The Vault

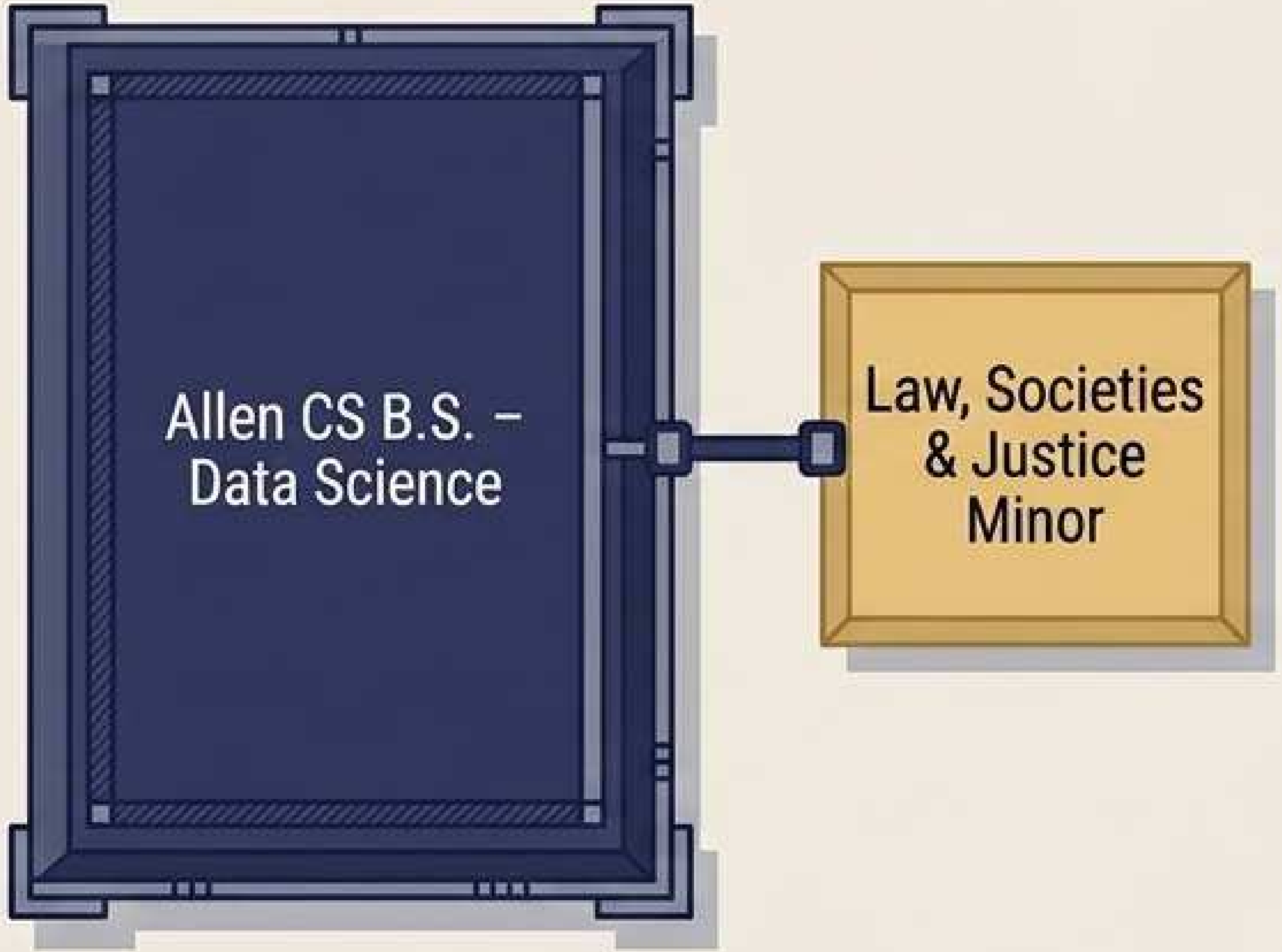
Direct-to-Major only. Structurally available only if admitted directly to the specific major on the initial first-year application. No backdoor access.

University of Washington – Seattle

System Score: 88.6 | Feasibility Gate: G3-DTM

The ultimate technical spine paired with a real undergraduate law-and-society complement.

Core + Satellite



The Architecture

The Data Science option supplies deep statistics/ML depth, while LSJ supplies structured study in social control, rights, and institutions.

Violin Continuity

UW Symphony and School of Music offer strong chamber and non-major private study options (audition dependent).

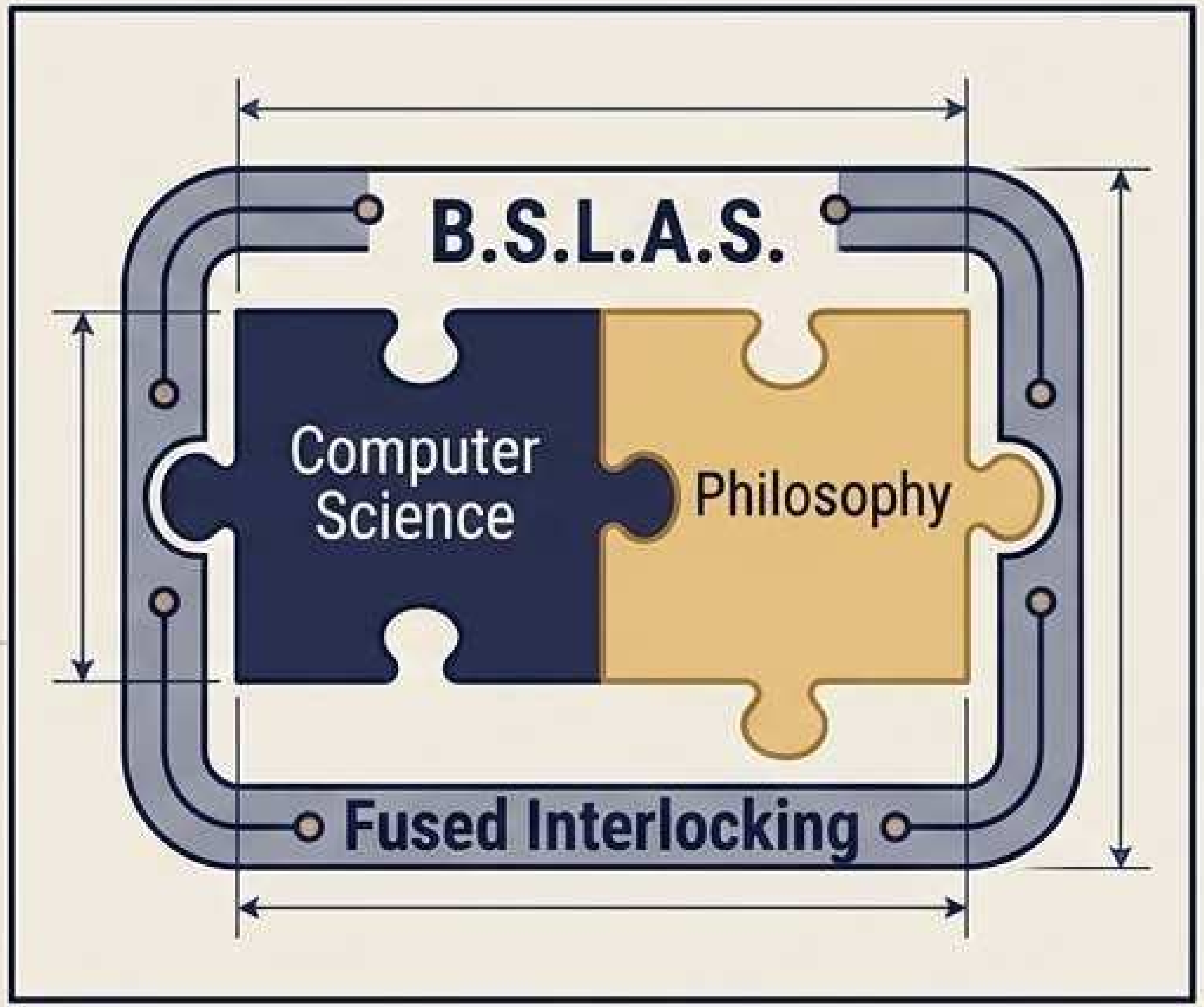
Critical Caveat

This path collapses without first-year Allen Direct-to-Major (DTM) admission. Eidee must apply CS/CE first-choice. Later entry is not a viable strategy.

University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign (UIUC)

System Score: 87.4 | Feasibility Gate: G3-Direct

A single integrated degree joining engineering-grade computing with the philosophy of mind, logic, and AI ethics.



The Architecture

Unlike a self-assembled double major, CS + Philosophy is one degree with a dedicated capstone. Technical and normative analysis are jointly required.

The Alignment

Directly maps to Eidee's interest in agency and intelligent machines, replacing scattered electives with formal "Minds & Machines" logic.

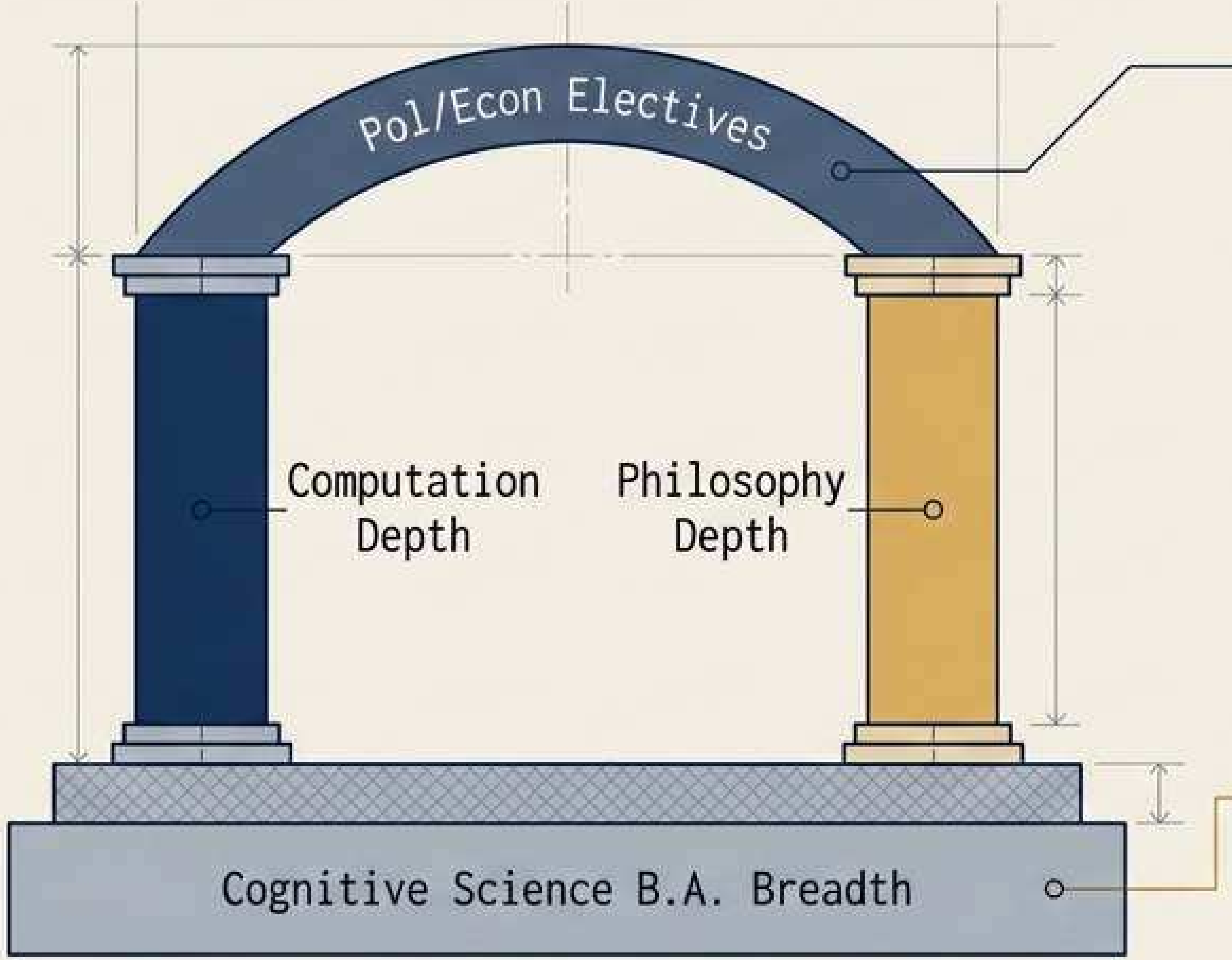
Critical Caveat

Leans heavily toward philosophy of technology rather than regulation/law. Eidee must actively use electives for political science and economics.

University of Chicago

System Score: 87.0 | Feasibility Gate: G3

The widest interdisciplinary base, allowing Eidee to build a custom intellectual architecture.



The Architecture

Formal six-field cognitive breadth combined with Eidee's choice of two depth areas, leaving explicit room for governance without requiring a second major.

The Alignment

Perfectly matches her broad AP preparation, converting intellectual range into a formally planned structure.

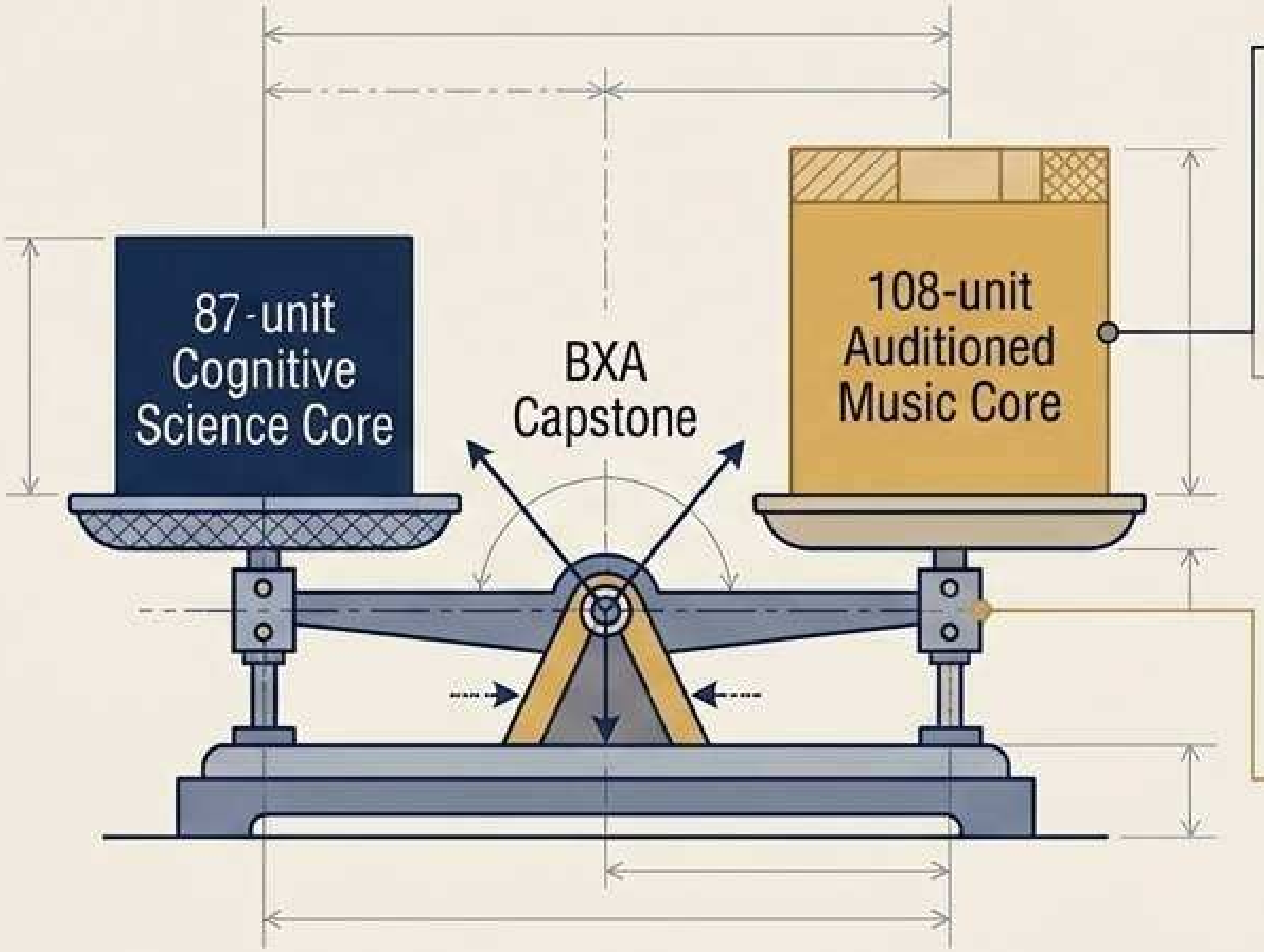
Critical Caveat

The technical floor is not guaranteed. Eidee must manually protect her CS depth (data structures, ML) to avoid the degree becoming purely theoretical.

Carnegie Mellon University (CMU)

System Score: 86.8 | Feasibility Gate: G2 (Audition/Review)

The definitive formal synthesis if Eidee sets the Music slider to M1 (Music inside the degree).



The Architecture

The BHA program perfectly balances a rigorous computational cognition core against graduate-level violin performance, bound by cross-disciplinary seminars.

The Alignment

Violin becomes a genuine intellectual method. The mandatory capstone directly supports human/AI musical interpretation.

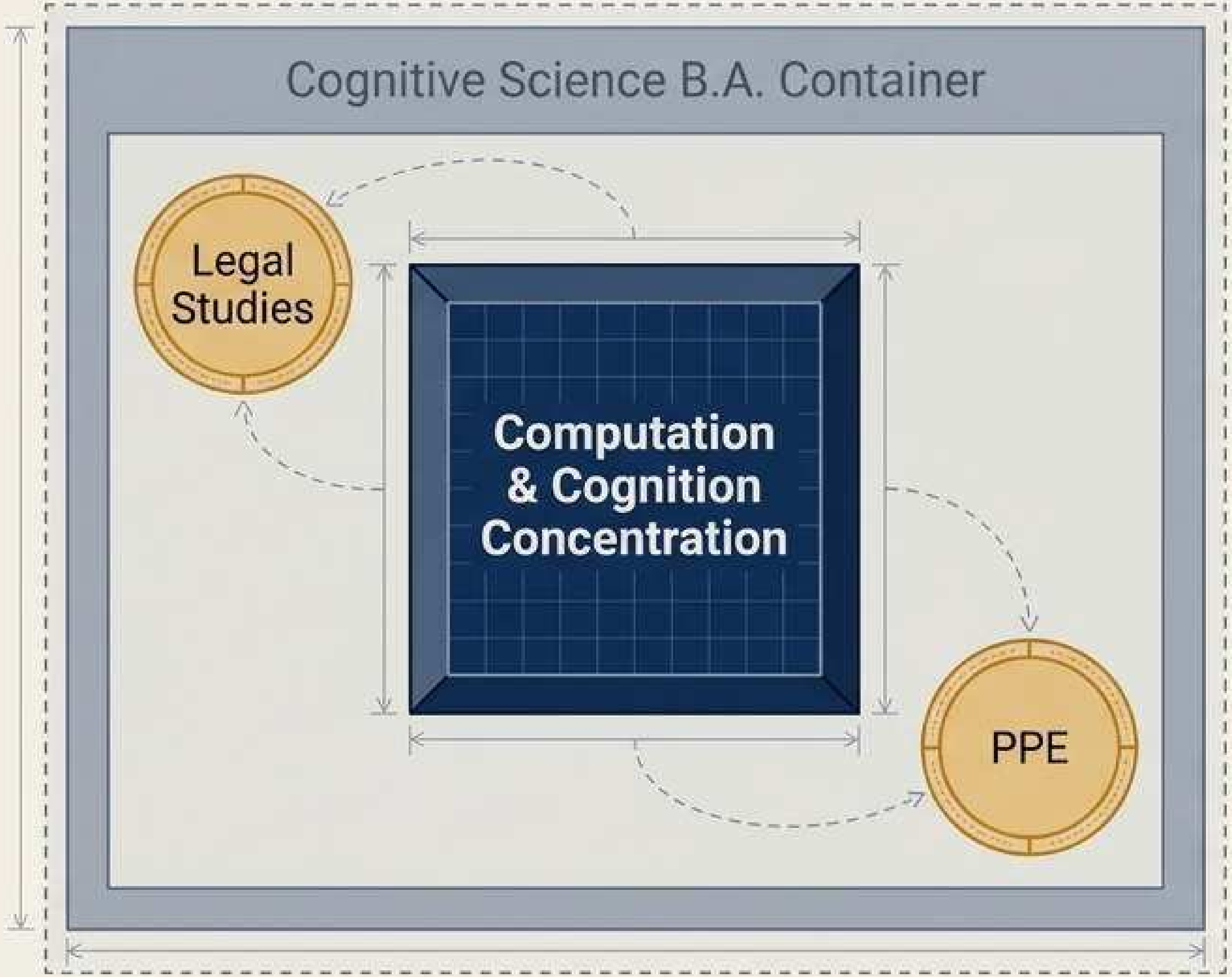
Critical Caveat

Highly demanding. Requires CFA/BXA review and live violin audition. Provides less built-in law/policy structure than CMU's Dietrich + SHIFT minor route.

University of Pennsylvania (UPenn)

| System Score: 84.2 | Feasibility Gate: G3 |

A broad cognitive core with a highly focused computational concentration and pre-law flexibility.



The Architecture

Six-field cognitive breadth anchors a **nine-course technical concentration**. Preserves a coherent AI core without requiring a separate engineering credential.

The Alignment

Leaves substantial space in the College of Arts & Sciences for dedicated legal studies, ethics, and political science electives.

Parameter Pivot

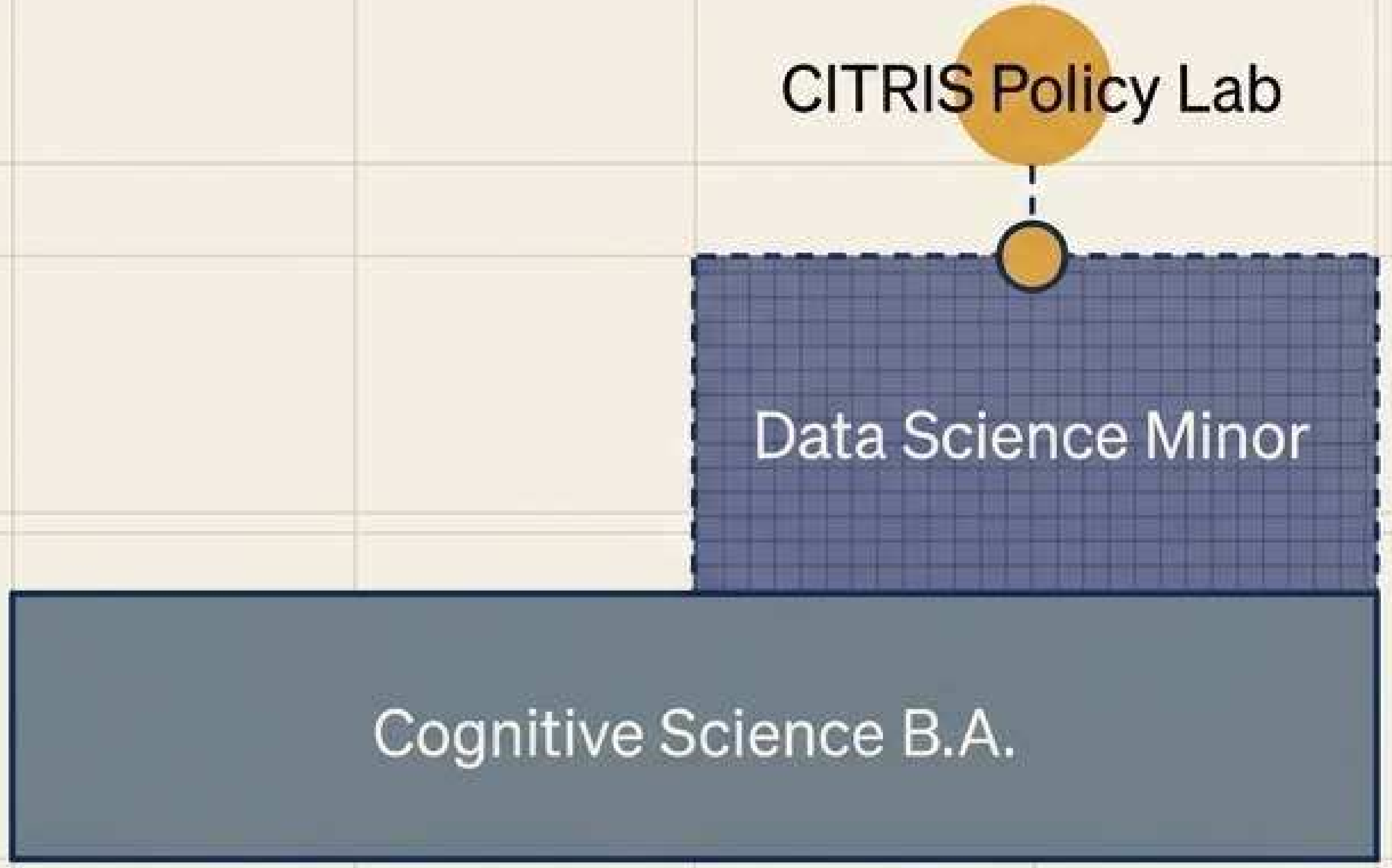
If the Economics slider hits E1/E2, UPenn becomes a **top-tier target** via **Wharton** B.S. Economics or CAS **Mathematical Economics**.

UC Berkeley

System Score: **83.2** | Feasibility Gate: **G3**

Broad cognition and AI foundations overlaid with an attainable, rigorous quantitative complement.

Foundation & Overlay



The Architecture

The Cognitive Science major requires strong computational modeling, which is reinforced and elevated by the formal Data Science minor.

The Alignment

Places Eidee directly adjacent to the CITRIS ecosystem, bridging technology with direct policy and societal governance questions.

Critical Caveat

Law/policy remains an elective theme, not a named degree component. Eidee must actively hunt for research access in a massive university system.

Diagnostic Matrix: The Six-School Comparison

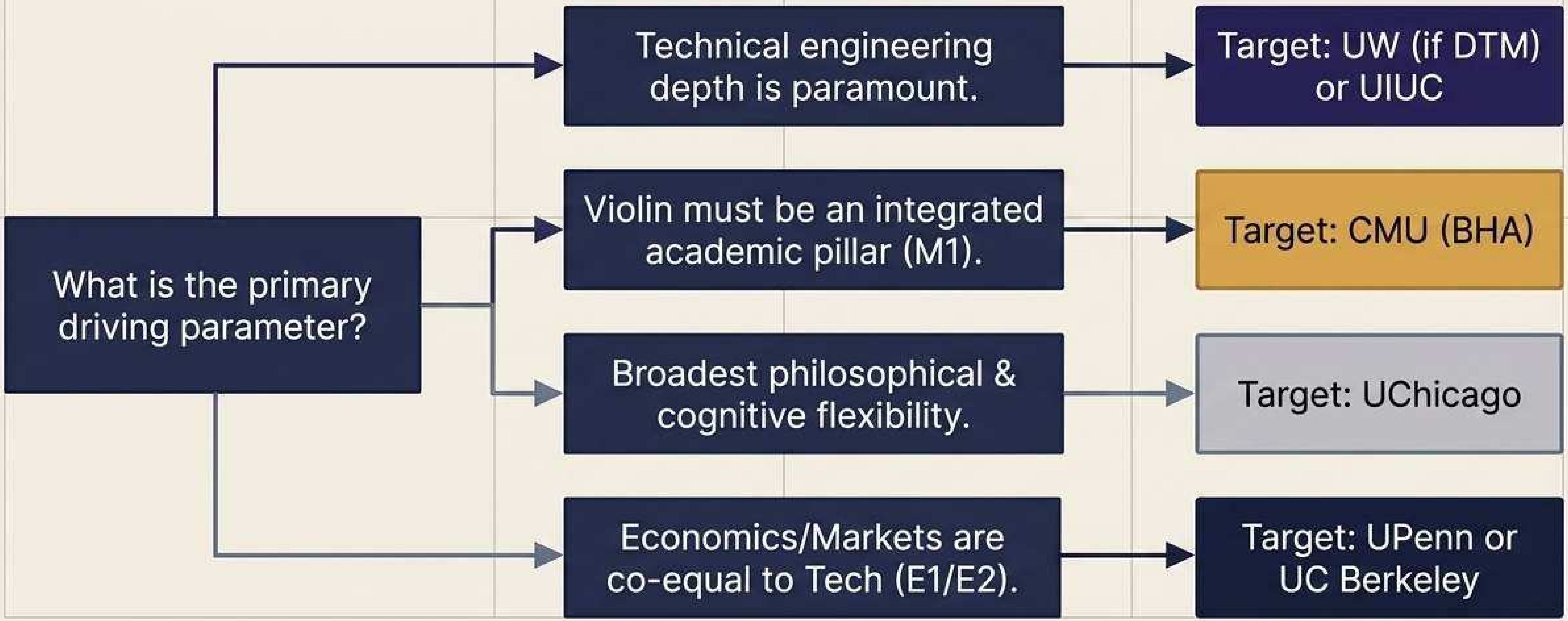
Distilling the architectural variables into baseline scores (assuming M0/E0 parameters).

University	**Tech Depth** (16%)	**Law/Ethics** (14%)	**Structure** (16%)	**Feasibility** (12%)	**Violin** (8%)
UW	5.0	4.5	4.5	3.5	5.0
UIUC	5.0	4.5	4.5	4.5	4.0
UChicago	3.5	4.0	4.5	4.5	4.0
CMU	4.5	3.0	5.0	3.5	5.0
UPenn	4.0	4.0	4.5	4.0	3.5
Berkeley	4.0	3.5	4.0	4.5	4.0

Key Insights: UW and UIUC dominate the technical floor. UChicago leads in adaptable cognitive design. CMU uniquely maximizes the Violin parameter.

Synthesis: The System Output

There is no single ‘best’ university—only the optimal architecture for her final system settings.



System Verification & Next Steps

Before executing the application strategy, the following variables must be confirmed.

1. Lock the Parameters	2. Confirm Admission Rules	3. Prepare the Art & Audit
Ask Eidee to finalize the M0/M1/M2 (Music) and E0/E1/E2 (Economics) slider positions. Define her minimum desired coding depth before narrowing narrowing targets.	Verify UW DTM residency logic, UIUC Direct-Choice rules, and Berkeley high-demand major policies for Fall 2027 entry.	If CMU remains a target, immediately verify prescreen repertoire requirements. Obtain official transcripts, AP score mappings, and a verified activity ledger.

Designing Eidee Laurel Tan’s Academic Architecture

A bespoke strategic briefing on the Cornell University pathway.

PREPARED FOR THE TAN FAMILY

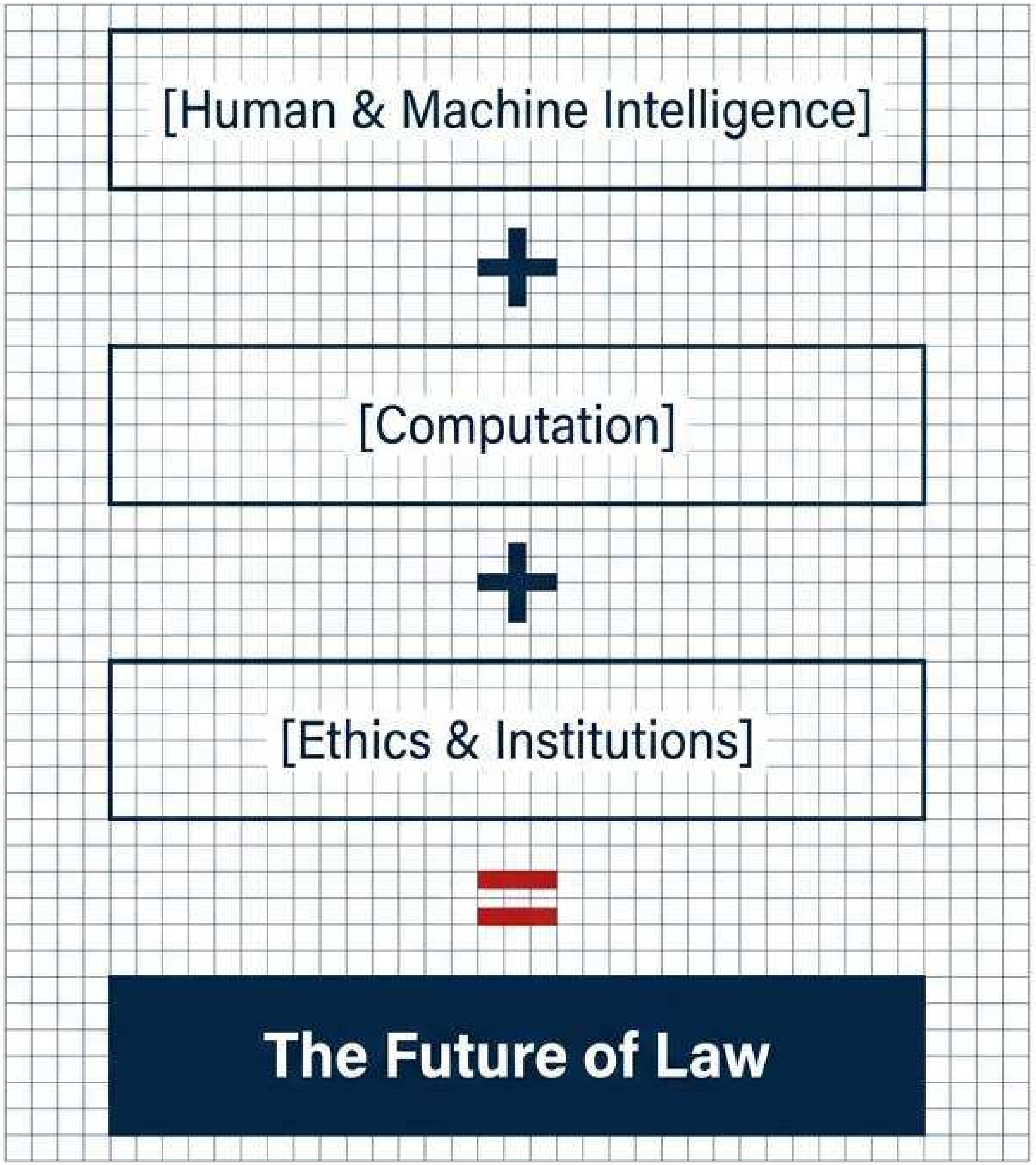
Cornell Information Science is the premier, purpose-built match for Eidee’s academic puzzle.

Core Thesis

Eidee’s best-fit undergraduate education is not a generic pre-law program. It is a deliberately structured education in intelligence, computation, and ethics, with law as the application domain.

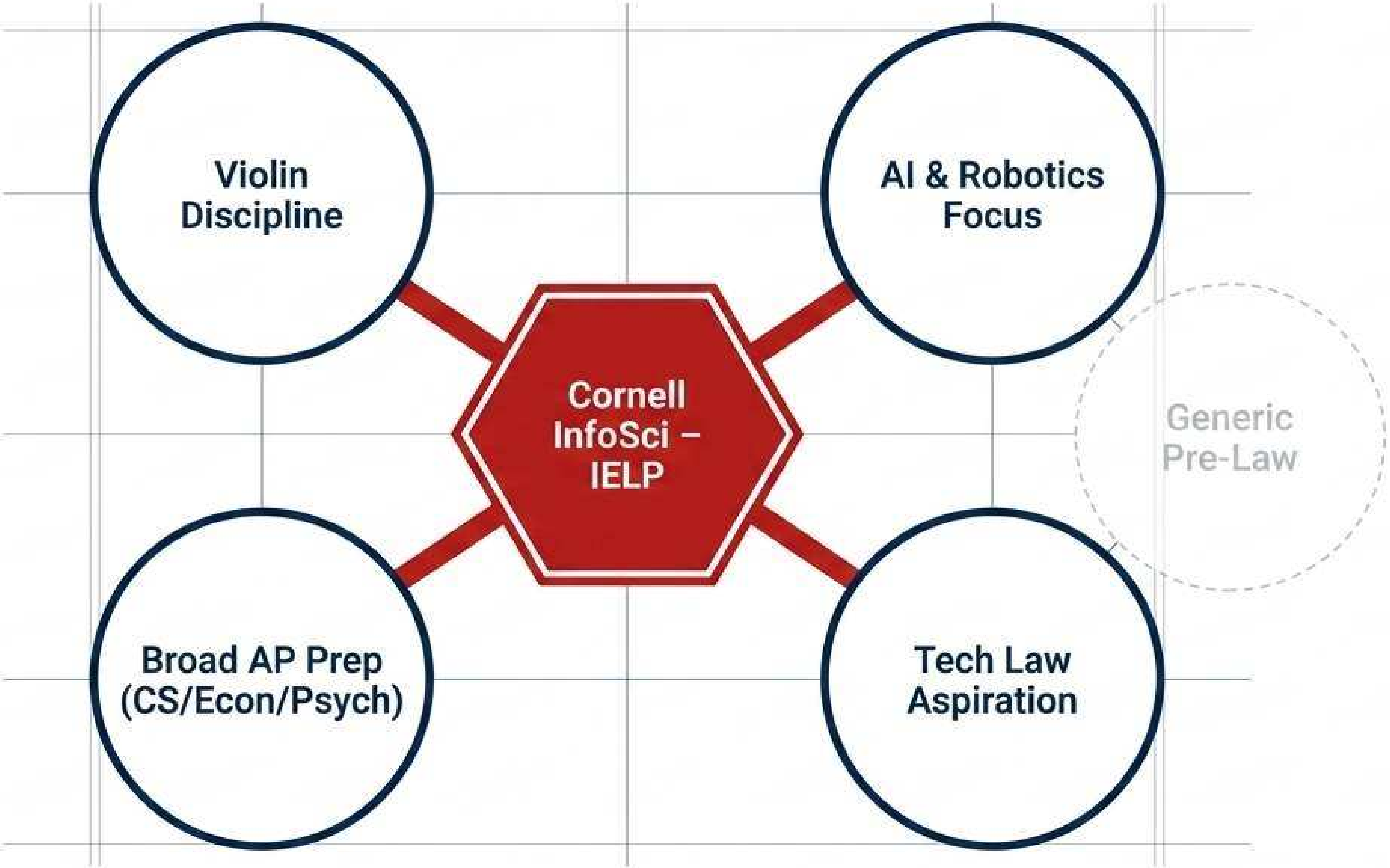
The Recommendation

Within a highly competitive 12-university field, Cornell University’s Information Science B.A. (with the Information Ethics, Law, and Policy concentration) stands out as the most explicit, structurally sound undergraduate technology-law curriculum available.

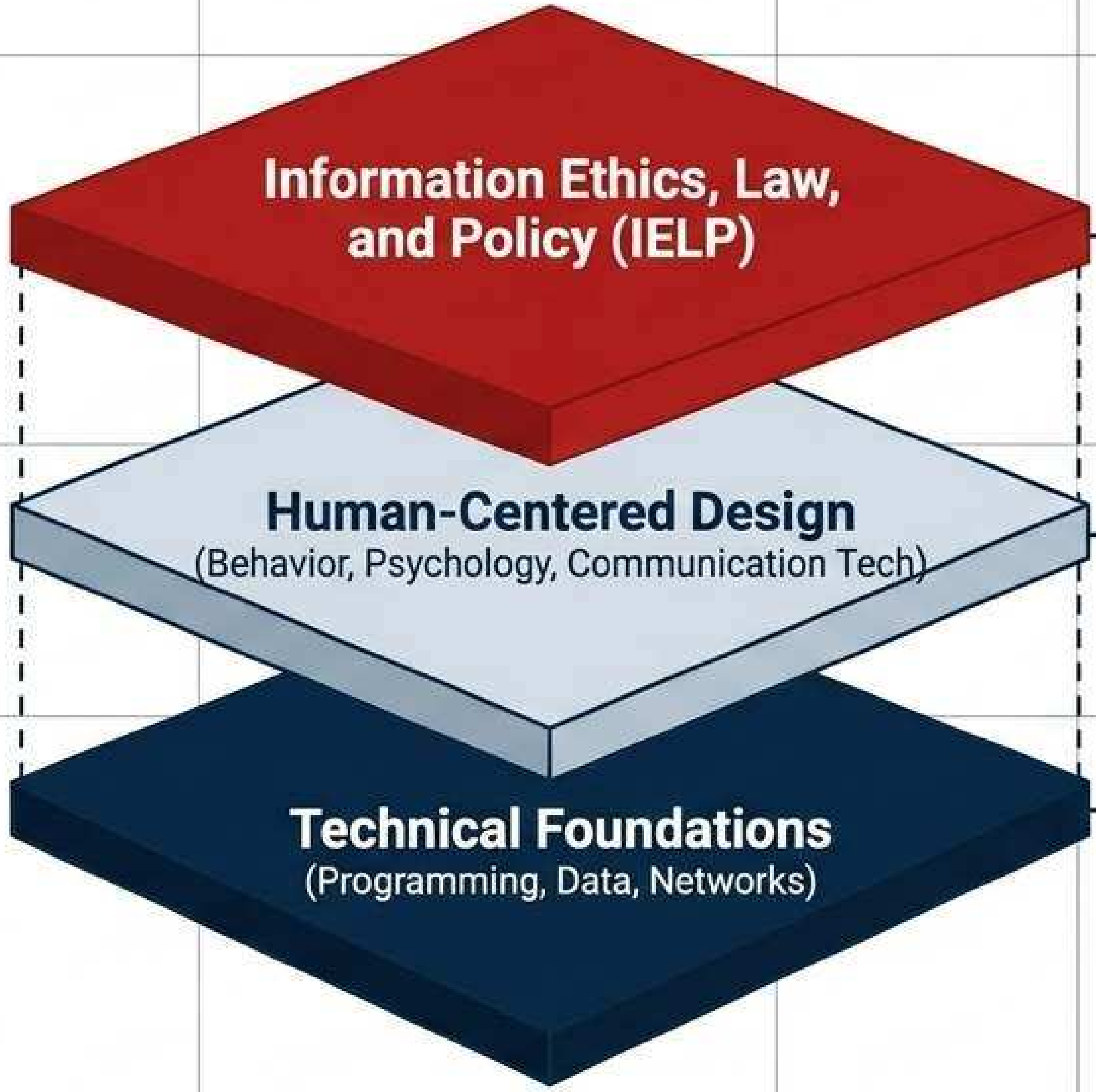


Moving beyond generic pre-law to a bespoke intellectual intersection

Key Insight
Generic pre-law pathways fragment Eidee's strengths, asking her to assemble a field from unrelated electives. Cornell provides a singular, interconnected academic home that naturally integrates her computational background with her institutional ambitions.



The structural anatomy of the Information Science B.A.



The Critical Differentiator
Explicitly includes technology law, privacy, cybersecurity, and regulatory policy functioning as the bridge between code and societal impact.

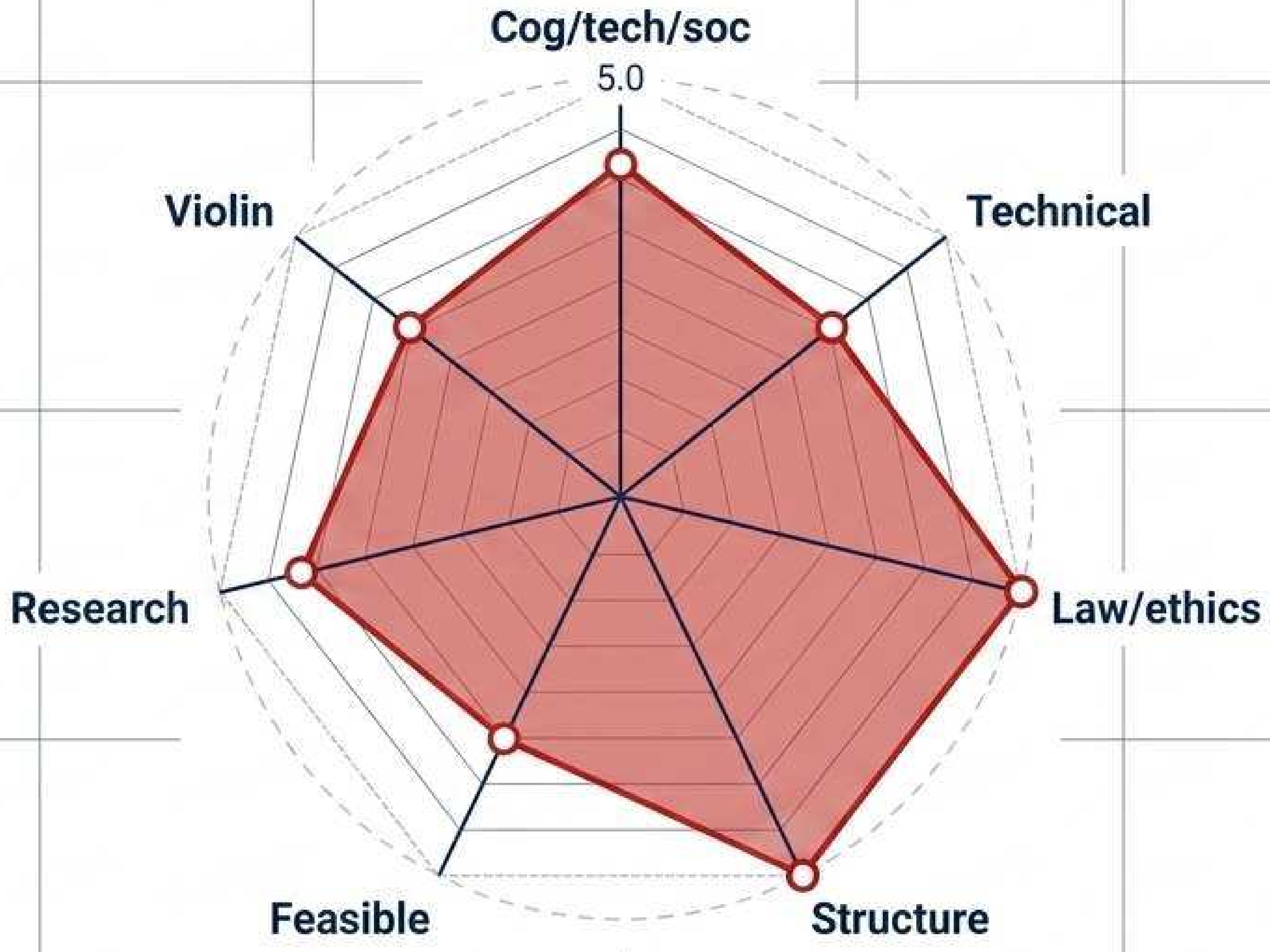
Satisfies her interest in empirical human cognition and behavior.

Translates Eidee's broad AP math and CS preparation into genuine technical literacy.

Aligning Eidee's verified strengths with **Cornell's** programmatic realities.

[Eidee's Verified Trait]	[Cornell Feature]	[Resulting Advantage]
Aspiration to govern AI and robotics.	Named **Information Ethics, Law, and Policy** (IELP) concentration.	Unusually direct preparation for analyzing regulation, privacy, and platform power.
Unusually broad AP preparation (Calc, CS, Psych, Econ).	**Computing, data, networks, and human-centered core requirements.**	Institutions and laws are studied with rigorous technical and behavioral literacy, not just theory.
Preference for a coherent interdisciplinary structure.	**Requirements-based Arts & Sciences affiliation.**	A coherent, legible path without relying on high-risk engineering-school internal transfers.

Visualizing Cornell's 89.4/100 quantitative fit score.



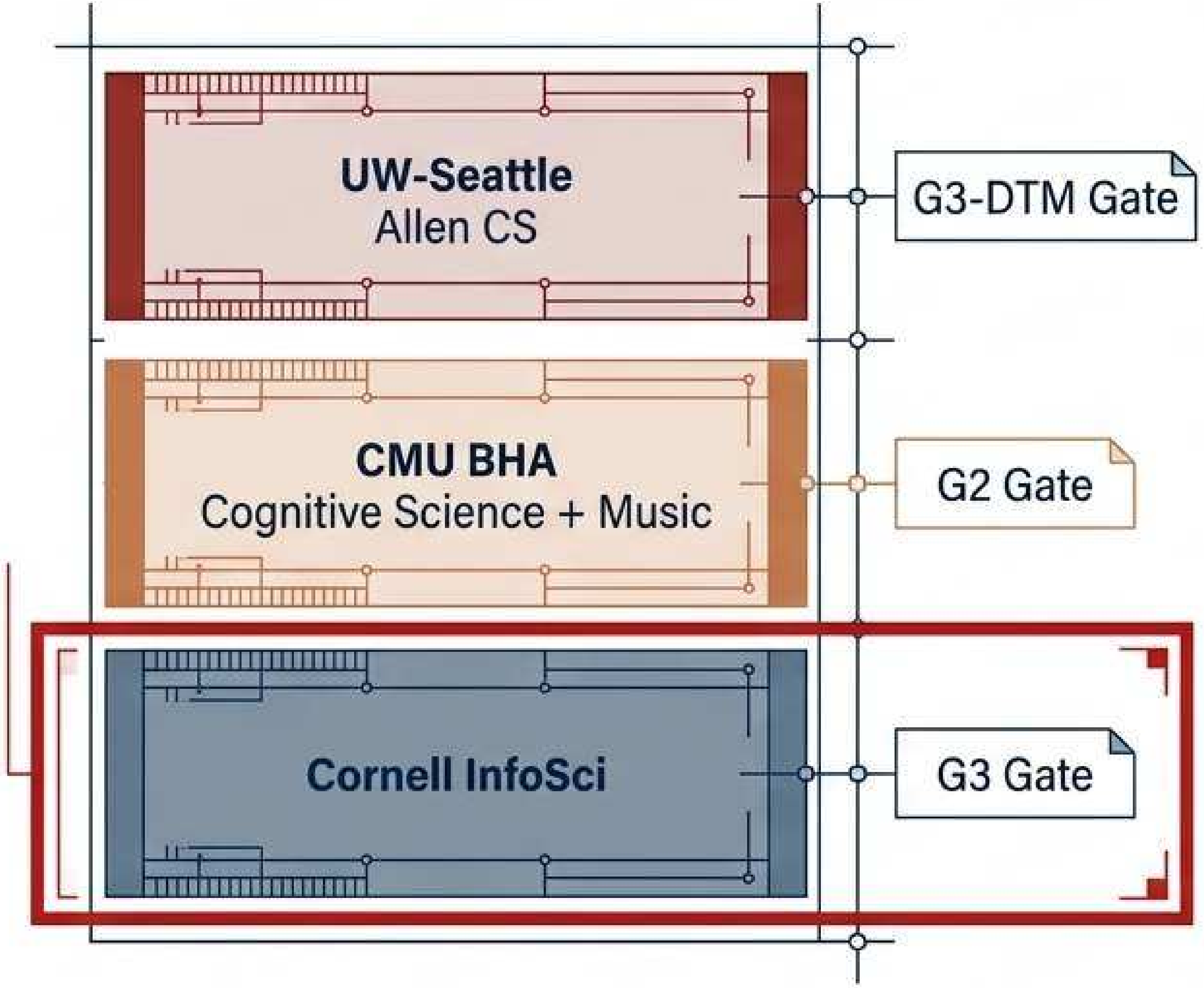
Axes weighted by Eidee's verified academic and super-curricular profile.

Data Insight

Cornell perfectly maxes out the **Law/Ethics** and **Coherent Structure** dimensions—the two most critical parameters for Eidee's pre-law horizon.

The slight dip in **Technical depth** (4.0 vs 5.0) reflects its focus on institutional impacts rather than pure engineering, which precisely matches her stated priorities.

Cornell offers structural security in a high-risk application landscape.



Cornell (G3): Structurally accessible. Transparent, published affiliation standards within Arts & Sciences. Highly controllable.

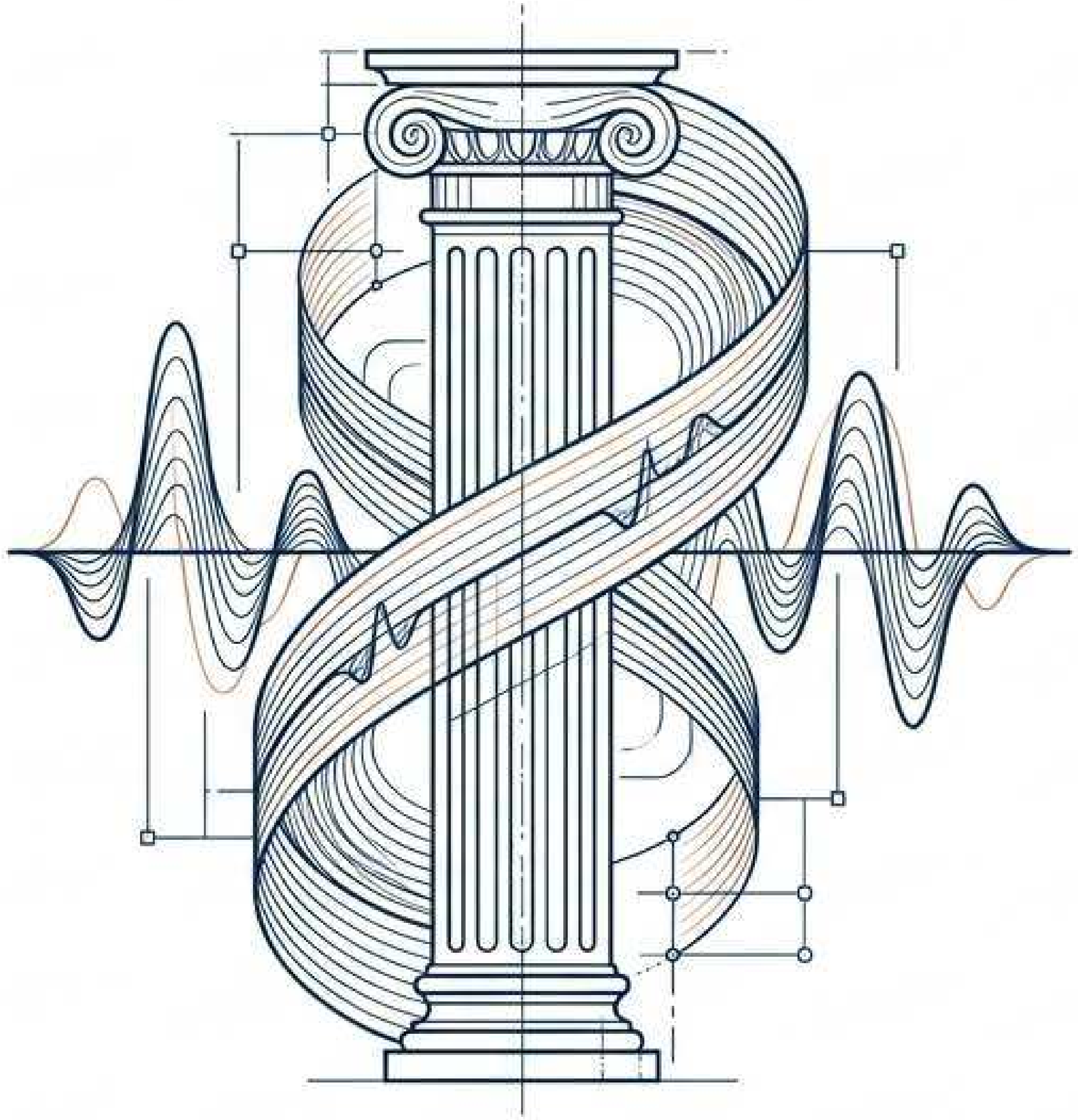
CMU (G2): Approval/Application dependent. Requires direct BXA/CFA intercollege review and a successful live violin audition.

UW-Seattle (G3-DTM): Direct-to-Major only. Requires first-year DTM admission to the Allen School. A general UW admission without DTM renders the recommended path completely inaccessible.

Evaluating comparative advantage within the elite peer group.

University	The Pathway	The Comparative Advantage
Stanford	SymSys B.S.–HAI	Best integrated version of human-centered AI and cognition.
Princeton	COS A.B. + Policy minors	Deepest computing combined with thesis-centered liberal arts.
MIT	Course 9 + STS	Strongest scientific study of cognition alongside technical research.
CMU	BHA CogSci + Music	Strongest formal integration of academic and artistic identities.
Cornell	**InfoSci B.A.–IELP**	The most **explicit undergraduate technology-law and policy** concentration in the competitive set.

Securing the violin trajectory without compromising the academic spine



The Parameter Pivot

Eidee's public corroboration (SCMS James Ehnes masterclass, UK International Music Competition) proves serious talent, but she currently targets a non-music profession. This requires an M0 setting: high-level super-curricular access, not a conservatory degree.

The Cornell Ecosystem

Cornell music courses and instrumental ensembles remain broadly open to non-majors via audition.

Strategic Trade-off

Unlike CMU's BXA program (which forces violin inside the academic degree), Cornell allows Eidee to dedicate her full academic credit load to technology and policy while preserving her artistic discipline extracurricularly.

Maintaining institutional fit even if academic parameters shift.

Primary Path (The Baseline)	Alternative 1 (The Economics Pivot)	Alternative 2 (The Builder Pivot)
Information Science B.A. Best if Eidee wants to balance technical foundations with the deepest possible dive into law, ethics, and human systems.	**Economics B.A. + InfoSci minor** Best if Eidee decides markets, incentives, econometrics, and institutional regulation must outrank human cognition. The IELP coursework remains accessible.	**Computer Science B.A. + InfoSci minor** Best if Eidee decides she wants to heavily build algorithms and audit systems at an engineering level, while keeping policy as a secondary lens.

Executing the Cornell Arts & Sciences pathway over four years.

	Year 1 (Foundations)	Year 2 (Affiliation)	Year 3 (Immersion)	Year 4 (Synthesis)
Core Arts & Sciences	Complete broad liberal arts foundations. Utilize AP credits for advanced placement in math and CS. Complete affiliation prerequisites.			
IELP Concentration		Formally affiliate with the Information Science major. Begin core Information Ethics, Law, and Policy (IELP) coursework.	Pursue policy practicums, laboratory research, or a technology-law internship. Consolidate technical and ethical literacies.	
Research & Practice				Complete an advanced, self-directed project joining a technical system (e.g., an algorithmic model) with a legal or ethical regime.

Critical verification steps before finalizing the application strategy.

Applicant Records

- [ ] Obtain official transcript, exact grading scale, and AP score reports.
- [ ] Obtain a verified activity ledger (with exact ensemble dates/hours).

Program Verifications

- [ ] Recalculate the Information Science map against the Fall 2027 Cornell catalog catalog (including AP double-count rules).
- [ ] Verify Fall 2027 non-major violin audition and lesson schedules.

Parameter Locks

- [ ] The family must definitively lock the Economics (E0 vs E1) and Music (M0 vs M1) parameter settings.
- [ ] Confirm Cornell Arts & Sciences remains the unquestioned primary target over CMU BXA or an MIT Economics hybrid.